

March CPI with Hormuz hit

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Reissue of the March CPI preview published April 10.



This is a reissue of March CPI Preview (published April 10) with breakdown of March quarter estimates of CPI and Trimmed Mean along with the month of March CPI and Trimmed Mean estimates. For the first time we include a breakdown of the CPI estimates for the next two months, April and May.

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- The Iran conflict is the largest energy shock since the oil crises of the 1970s/80s. For more details on the scenario underpinning these projections please refer to [Middle East Crisis Update](#).
- Westpac is forecasting a 1.5%qtr/4.2%yr gain in the March quarter CPI. The Trimmed Mean is forecast to lift 0.9%qtr/3.5%yr.
- Headline inflation is now peaking at 5.4%yr in the June quarter before easing back to 4.6%yr by end 2026.
- Core inflation peaks around 4%yr in the second half of 2026 and does not return to 3%yr till the end of 2027.
- The monthly CPI to rise 1.3% in March and April with the annual pace peaking at 5.8%yr in May.
- The Trimmed Mean is set to rise 0.2% in March followed by 0.5% increase in April; the annual pace peaks around 4%yr in June and holds this pace till year end.
- Pass-through to construction inputs has been reported by Tradelinks to be greater than usual.

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